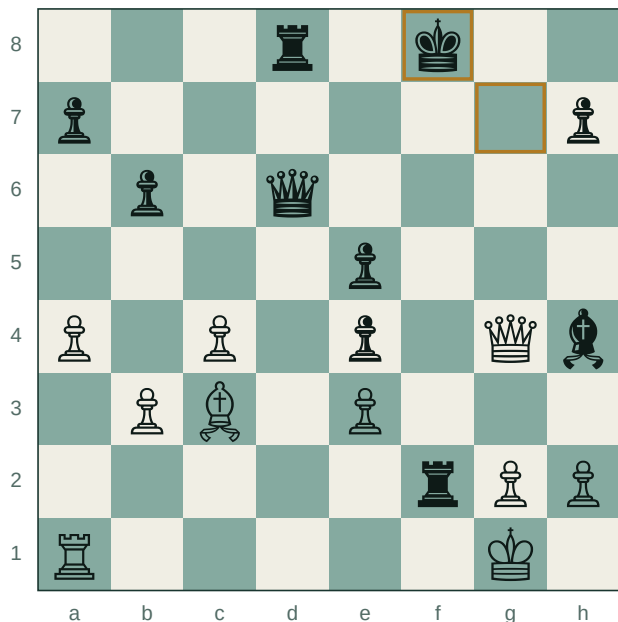


Pins and pressure: White, move 26

Pins and pressure

White to move



Previous move: 25...Kf8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

26. Qxh4 Rf5 27. Bb4 Qxb4 28. Qxd8+

26.Qxh4 The queen captures the bishop on h4. From h4 it attacks rook on f2 and rook on d8. Recorded reply: **26...Rf5**.

27.Bb4 The bishop moves from c3 to b4. Recorded reply: **27...Qxb4**.

28.Qxd8+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on d8.

At the end, nominal material is White 20 / Black 19 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -4 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on f8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on h4. Check for tactical protection.